

HSE TOOLBOX TALK

DROPPED-OBJECT PREVENTION

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Review injury, equipment-damage and production-loss hazards caused by tools, materials and equipment falling from height, scaffolds, platforms and lifting areas, and verify tethering, exclusion-zone and lower-area controls before work begins. Even a small nut, wrench or hand tool can cause serious injury when dropped from height. The severity depends on the object's weight, drop height, shape and impact point.

KEY HAZARDS

1



DROPPED TOOL

2



LOOSE MATERIAL

3



OPEN EDGE

4



WIND

5



STACKING

6



TRANSFER

7



PERSON BELOW

8



TETHER FAILURE

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

≥ 9 cm

Minimum toeboard height

0

People in the drop zone

100%

Suitable secondary retention for small tools



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1926.501(c), 1926.502(j) and 1926.759 require source retention, toeboards / screens, material control and protection below.

OSHA 1926.501(c)

FALLING-OBJECT PROTECTION

Protect employees using toeboards, screens, guardrails, canopies or by keeping objects back from edges.

OSHA 1926.502(j)

TOEBOARDS AND SCREENS

Install strong toeboards at least 9 cm high with limited openings; use panels or screens for higher materials.

OSHA 1926.759(a)

LOOSE ITEMS

Secure loose materials, equipment and tools used aloft and remove them when work is complete.

SAHA PROSEDÜRÜ

TOOL TETHERING

Verify tether, anchor and tool connection ratings and suitability; do not use improvised retention.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Dropped-object risk assessment | ☐ Tools / materials-at-height register |
| ☐ Tether and connection inspection | ☐ Toeboard / net inspection |
| ☐ Exclusion-zone and spotter plan | ☐ Material-transfer method |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Which tools will be used at height today?
- Are tool lanyards and attachment points suitable?
- How will small components be carried and stored?

SOURCE RETENTION AND AREA ISOLATION BELOW



Tool tether - Secured material - Toeboard - Net - Barrier - Spotter

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. KEEP UNNEEDED ITEMS OFF HEIGHT

Secure tools with suitable tool lanyards. Keep small parts in closed bags or containers.

2. SECURE AT SOURCE

Do not leave loose materials near platform edges. Check toe boards, netting and edge protection. Barricade the lower area and create an exclusion zone.

3. PROTECT EDGES AND OPENINGS

Raise and lower materials using controlled methods. Secure loose components before moving loads. Assess wind conditions and lightweight materials.

4. ISOLATE THE AREA BELOW

Clean platforms completely after the task. Stop work when dropped-object risk is identified.

CRITICAL WARNING



Every tool and material used at height can fall. Secure it, contain it, barricade the area and keep people out of the line of fire.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Tools tethered | ☐ Tool bags closed |
| ☐ Small parts secured | ☐ Toe boards complete |
| ☐ Edge protection suitable | ☐ Lower area barricaded |
| ☐ Loads secured | ☐ Wind acceptable |
| ☐ Platform clean | |

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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site:

Date:

Presented by:

Work area:

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			